Community-Based Support Service
For Veterans, Wounded Soldiers and Their Families

Introduction

PHIERS is the Public Health Information Exchange and Referral Service (PHIERS). The goal of PHIERS.org is to help nonprofits that serve vulnerable populations improve performance, capacity and ability to collaborate with other providers of care for beneficiaries of government-funded services.

- PHIERS.org and its member organizations have defined and developed an evidence-based toolkit that will improve the quality, continuity and cost-effectiveness of care provided between services and care settings
- The project will launch in Fall 2014, and create a holistic health home that links public health and social service providers to veteran and wounded soldier advocacy programs, patients, providers and caregivers (stakeholders)
- We will provide access to full complement of community-based wrap around support services that meet needs of the whole person (mind/body/spirit), family and community.
- We will provide ready access to coordinated interventions / public / social services on behalf of veterans, injured service members and other vulnerable populations, after deploying/piloting our solution for ex-offenders.

PHIERS.org wishes to help Maryland's Department of Veterans Affairs connect service members, caregivers and struggling families to the local resources they need to find near term relief in the areas of:

- Wrap-around Support for Veterans and Ex-Offenders
- Public health and social support services
- Mental health, counseling, job training and placement
- Food, housing and human services

We believe that by working together, PHIERS.org and its members can provide near term relief and decision support to assist the VA with its backlog

- Our solution will assist with pre-registration and enrollment tasks, provide triage and resource matching services to connect beneficiaries to the resources they need in a timely fashion
- We use a VistA-compatible health record to securely coordinate care across settings
- We use best practices to improve upon existing registration, eligibility and enrollment processes – enabling the VA to more quickly process incoming service members.
- We have unique knowledge about

What would we like to happen?

- We want to tailor our solution to fit the need the MD's veterans… and deploy on behalf of veterans, wounded soldiers and caregivers/families across the state
- WE want to leverage synergies, and help other government agencies benefit from the VA's success
- We will connect veterans to the resources they need to get near term and coordinated access to care

Roles, Training and Infrastructure

Thousands of nonprofits in the local region share a common mission and are already serving veterans, wounded soldiers and struggling families, many of whom are associated with the faith community.

- What is needed is a way to connect patients/caregivers to the decision support, counseling services and local resources they need to improve access to available resources, in a coordinated and compassionate manner.
- In this way, we can improve access to, and increase the number of options available to the VA, and the veterans, families and communities it serves.

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THE ANSWER: PHIERS (Pronounced "fires", as in transformation)

- **PHIERS is a HIPAA/NIEM-compliant health information service, case management and resource matching tool** that enables patient advocates and caregivers to promote continuity of care across settings, multidisciplinary care teams, functionally separate organizations and government agencies in a timely, cost-effective and sustainable manner.
  - **For example,** veteran ex-offenders may receive services from the VA, CMS, DHHS, DOJ and HUD.
  - **PHIERS.org understands** the way the VA works and processes information internally, and with external agencies (ref flowcharts).
- **PHIERS will launch in Fall 2014 in Prince George's County**, and plans to mirror its deployment in Baltimore - to prove that it is an easily scalable, replicated and sustainable solution for the issues that the VA is facing.
  - Our goal is to provide decision support, resource matching and near term primary care / social support services for veterans, wounded soldiers and struggling families.
  - We will accomplish this goal by connecting them to trusted, best-of-breed nonprofit organizations that have a common agenda, a shared measurement system, mutually reinforced activities that help the VA deliver on its promise to care for those who have served and sacrificed for our freedom.

Measurable Results in 5 Steps

- ***Step 1:*** Engage local public health and social safety net providers in collective impact project, with shared information service to coordinate care across settings (DONE)
- ***Step 2:*** Tailor and Deploy the Toolkit to enable participating nonprofits to coordinate care across functionally separate organizations and multi-disciplinary care teams. (IN PROGRESS)
- ***Step 3:*** Coordinate Interventions on behalf of veteran ex-offenders, and then veterans with special needs, before opening the solution up to all veterans
- ***Step 4:*** Verify coordinated care across settings in prep to expand upon an evidence-based care transition program proven to improve outcomes, reduce ER visits and readmissions.
- ***Step 5:*** Expand services to meet the needs of wounded soldiers with more acute and comprehensive care needs

Summary

- PHIERS is a collective impact program designed to help front line health and social service providers help VAMCs make timely referrals to participating local nonprofit service providers in the areas of:
  - Primary care, social support services, navigators and decision aides
  - Medical transport, home health and caregiver support services
  - HIPAA coordinate interventions and care on behalf of patients and families across settings
- PHIERS.org connects veterans to the wrap-around resources they need to make better informed decisions and expand access to community services that can provide relief, in a coordinated manner.

QUALIFICATIONS

- PHIERS (pronounced "fires", as in transformation), is based on years of firsthand experience with VistA, VA Medical Centers (VAMCs) and the need of a network of wrap-around service providers for patients/caregivers.
- A growing list of nonprofits are have partnered with public health and social service providers and PHIERS.org to use a shared information infrastructure to promote continuity of care across settings
- Partnered with MD market leader in Emergency Care to deploy HIPAA/NIEM-Compliant health information service and care transition program to facilitate continuity of care across settings.

CONTACT US

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